

Player Brief — Zach Freitas

Prepared for Max Allen, SWINGWORX Golf Performance · September 2026

About me

- **52, right-handed.** Arccos handicap **18.1**. It came down from 27.5 in 2023 to a low of 16.4 this summer, and has slipped back since.
- Home course is Twin Oaks (White tees, about 5,600 yd). I play about 1.5 rounds a month, usually 9 holes. A typical score is 49 for 9 and low 90s for 18.
- **Physical:** my mobility is decent for my age. My **right wrist is tight bending backward** (extension) from an old injury. I don't know whether it limits my swing. I also wonder whether I'm losing speed in my shoulders or knees.
- **Data I track:** Arccos on every round (58 rounds, 3,386 shots) and a Foresight GC3 at the range (178 shots, Feb–Jul 2026).

What I want from lessons

1. Lower my handicap.
2. Find out if I'm **leaking speed through my mechanics**, fix it, and learn what's realistic at 52.
3. Consistent long irons that hold greens.
4. Honest guidance on whether any equipment change is warranted, **after** the swing is sorted.

Swing — what my launch-monitor data says

Medians of well-struck shots (smash ≥ 1.25) on the GC3:

Club	Club spd	Smash	Carry	Launch	Spin	Descent	Spin axis	Mishit rate
Driver 10.5°	84.5	1.42	139	12.0°	970	18°	54° L	10%
3H 19°	79.2	1.44	164	14.3°	2,380	27°	15° L	12%
4H 22°	76.6	1.35	149	17.9°	2,930	31°	9° L	0%
5i 25.5°	76.1	1.40	149	14.2°	2,735	29°	14° L	54%
7i 33°	75.4	1.33	133	18.3°	4,920	39°	4° L	50%

My read, which I'd like you to confirm or correct:

1. **Strike consistency is the biggest problem.** Half my iron swings are mishits. Counting every shot, the 7i median carry falls to 122 yd (SD 29), and the 5i to 118 (SD 37).
2. **Face closes relative to path, and it gets worse as the club gets longer.** Path is near zero with every club, but the spin axis goes from 4° left on the 7i to 54° left on the driver. My driver speed should carry about 190 yd; my median is 139 because of the hook.
3. **The 5i launches OK but spins too little (about 2,700 rpm) and lands too flat (29°)** to hold a green. I suspect strike location, not loft, but I have no face or impact data.
4. **Speed:** the 5i is only about 0.7 mph faster than the 7i, when I'd expect 2–3 mph more. That's a small gap, not a big leak. Driver speed of 84.5 mph is my overall ceiling question.

Caveats: my GC3 had no club-data add-on, so I have no face, path-at-impact, dynamic loft or impact-location data. The 7i and 5i sessions were months apart. Arccos putt distances come from GPS and are approximate.

Strategy — what the course data says

Strokes gained per 18 holes vs a scratch golfer (Arccos):

	Approach	Off the tee	Putting	Short game	Total
Career	-9.2	-6.2	-4.5	-3.3	-23.2
Last 5 rounds (Aug-Sep)	-14.4	-8.1	-2.3	-2.5	-27.3

Approach by distance (Arccos's own breakdown):

From	50–100 yd	100–150 yd	150–200 yd	200+ yd
SG per round	-1.4	-4.2	-2.3	-1.0
SG per shot	-0.29	-0.50	-0.48	-0.28

- **Long irons are my worst clubs per swing; 100–150 yd costs me the most per round.** Each swing from 100–150 and 150–200 costs about half a stroke. I just hit twice as many from 100–150. Arccos lists 100–150 as my #1 "hurting" area.

Strokes gained per shot by club, last 12 months (best → worst):

Wedges*	8i	9i	7i	3H	Driver	3W	PW	6i	5i	4H
-0.23	-0.26	-0.27	-0.28	-0.30	-0.31	-0.32	-0.34	-0.48	-0.66	-0.67

*Arccos combines my 52/56/60 under one label, mostly chips and short approaches. My 8-iron is my best full-swing club. From 150–200 yd I hit only about 14% of greens, and my 5i also misses right.

- **I come up short: 51% of my approaches finish short of the green** (5% long, about 10% each left and right). I hit 24% of greens against Arccos's 56% goal for my level. That points to too little distance (mishits, speed, or taking too little club), not direction.
- **Driving:** median drive 193 yd, 49% fairways. Short drives leave me long approaches, so I get inside 100 yd in regulation on only 12% of par 4s.
- **Gapping looks messy on course:** 3W 193 → 3H 164 (a 29-yd hole), 3H and 4H only 3 yd apart, 4H 161 vs 5i 142. These are Arccos Smart Distances (total yards).

Mentality

- My last 5 rounds are my worst stretch: 45% of holes were double bogey or worse, and I hit 16% of greens (28% before).
- Putting and short game have *improved*. The slump is my full swing.
- Makes inside 6 ft dropped to about 69% lately. My putter is fine; I think it's pressure and technique.

Questions for Max

Swing and diagnosis (TrackMan + video)

1. **Dynamic loft, spin loft and impact location** on my 5i and driver. Is the low spin from strike location, the face, or delivery?
2. **Face-to-path and closure rate.** Where does the left curve come from? Is the driver's 54° left spin axis real, or a GC3 artifact?
3. **Does my tight right-wrist extension** limit my wrist angle at the top or shaft lean at impact? Should I get a mobility screen or see a PT?
4. **Shoulder turn and lower-body sequencing.** Am I leaking speed there?
5. **Realistic speed gain at 52** from sequencing alone vs adding speed training? I hit almost 101 mph on a Rypstick but it never showed up with the driver. Why, and what wrist-safe protocol would you use?

Equipment (after the swing is sorted)

6. **Would I be better off with MOI-matched or frequency-matched irons than swing-weight-matched ones?** Which of the two suits me, and would you combine them?
7. **Would flighted shafts help** me get the right flight and gaps by club?
8. **Are my shafts too light for me?** (Irons MMT 75 S; woods Speeder NX S.) Does the answer change with my tempo and transition?
9. **Do my clubs fit me overall?** I dislike the **feel** of my irons (harsh, clicky) and the **flight height** of most clubs (5i lands at 29°, driver peaks near 29 ft). I value predictable gaps. Bag: P770 5–PW, Qi10 driver/3W/3H/4H, MG4 52/56/60.
10. **Are cleated spikes limiting my ground use and speed?** Would spikeless shoes or a different spike help me move dynamically?

Practice and playing

11. **What exercises and practice should I do between lessons?** I play about 1.5 rounds a month, so what is the best use of limited range time?
12. **What are the top 1–2 changes to make first,** and how will we measure progress (strike rate, spin axis, speed)?
13. **How do I cut mishits?** Any impact-tape, spray or drill feedback I can use alone?
14. **Which long clubs should I keep** (5i and 4H are my worst per shot, and the 3W–3H gap is 29 yd)? Should I club up, since 51% of approaches finish short?
15. **How do I handle pressure?** What pre-shot routine would you give me for the late-round slump and short putts?
16. **Do you offer playing lessons, and are they on a real course or simulated?** Could we do one at Twin Oaks? Also, can I get my TrackMan reports and video after each session?